

IMPLEMENTING RULES AND REGULATIONS OF REPUBLIC ACT NO. 12310, OTHERWISE KNOWN AS THE "EXPANDED PHILIPPINE SCIENCE HIGH SCHOOL (PSHS) SYSTEM ACT"

[Status note: These are the current Implementing Rules and Regulations (IRR) of Republic Act No. 12310, approved 29 April 2026. Section numbers in this document refer to the IRR, not to RA 12310 itself.]

Pursuant to Section 22 of Republic Act No. 12310, titled "An Act Expanding the Philippine Science High School (PSHS) System, Further Strengthening its Governance and Management, Repealing for the Purpose Republic Act No. 8496 or the "Philippine Science High School System Act of 1997", and Appropriating Funds Therefor", the following Rules and Regulations are hereby promulgated to implement the provisions of the aforesaid law.

SEC. 1. Title. - These Rules shall be known and cited as the Implementing Rules and Regulations of Republic Act No. 12310, also known as the "Expanded Philippine Science High School (PSHS) System Act, and referred to as "IRR".

RULE I - POLICIES AND OBJECTIVES

SEC. 2. Declaration of Policy. - The provisions of this IRR are in line with the policy of the State to promote science and technology (S&T), research and development (R&D), invention, and innovation, and their utilization. The State recognizes the need to enhance Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics (STEM) education, training, and services, and support appropriate and self-reliant scientific and technological capabilities and their application to increase productivity and enhance the quality of life for everyone. Towards this end, the State established the PSHS System that shall assume a leadership role in secondary STEM education.

SEC. 3. Objectives. - The Act and this IRR aim to achieve the following objectives:

- 3.1 Establish strategically accessible PSHS campuses that provide, on scholarship basis, secondary education programs with special emphasis on STEM for students with exceptional aptitude in science and mathematics;
- 3.2 Increase the pool of high school graduates who will pursue undergraduate courses in the field of STEM, undertake R&D, or pursue careers in S&T;
- 3.3 Consolidate existing and future campuses under a unified system of governance and management to ensure consistent quality standards and efficient operations;
- 3.4 Support the holistic development of scholars, faculty and staff by facilitating and encouraging participation in international collaborations, local and international competitions, academic symposia, research projects, and other similar activities; and
- 3.5 Ensure that students with exceptional aptitude in science and mathematics are given equal scholarship opportunities to enroll in the PSHS System.

RULE II - DEFINITION

SEC. 4. Definition of Terms. - For purposes of this IRR, the following terms shall be defined as follows:

- 4.1 Act refers to Republic Act No. 12310 or the "Expanded Philippine Science High School (PSHS) System Act";
- 4.2 Administrative Regions refer to the regions where the Department of Science and Technology (DOST) holds regional offices;
- 4.3 Careers in S&T refer to the pursuit of professions in the fields of basic and applied sciences, such as STEM education and such other disciplines approved by the PSHS System Board of Trustees created by the Act;
- 4.4 Philippine Science High School refers to secondary school offering scholarship-based education to qualified students with exceptional aptitude in STEM to prepare them for careers in S&T;
- 4.5 Philippine Science High School System Board of Trustees, hereinafter referred to as the Board, refers to the governing body that exercises overall authority and supervision, and provides policy direction over the PSHS System.
- 4.6. Philippine Science High School National Alumni Association (PSHS NAA) refers to the Board-recognized organization of alumni or graduates of existing and future PSHS campuses duly registered under the laws of the Philippines;
- 4.7 Qualified Students refer to those who qualify for admission through the PSHS National Competitive Examination or other similar admission processes approved by the Board such as, but not limited to, the Lateral Admission Qualifying Examination (LAQE), and Requirement for Admission, Criteria, and Evaluation (RACE);
- 4.8 Scholarship refers to the awards or grants for secondary education given by the PSHS System to deserving students; and
- 4.9 Term of office refers to the period fixed by the Act within which a public official may hold office.

RULE III - SCOPE

SEC. 5. Establishment and Expansion of the PSHS System. - The PSHS System shall be established under the administrative supervision of the DOST, composed of at least two (2) PSHS campuses in each administrative region of the country: Provided, That PSHS campuses within the same region shall not be situated in the same province, or in the same city in the case of the National Capital Region: Provided, further, That the establishment of additional campuses shall be subject to a comprehensive review based on need, demand, and other criteria determined by the Board.

5.1 The Board shall prescribe and approve the policies, guidelines, and criteria governing the establishment of new campuses.

5.1.1 In determining the establishment of new campuses, the Board shall be guided by such criteria as it may prescribe, which may include, among others, the following general considerations:

5.1.1.1 Demonstrated need and demand for PSHS educational services in the proposed service area, including the availability of qualified prospective students;

5.1.1.2 Suitability and legal availability of the proposed site, including compliance with minimum land area and other site requirements as may be determined by the Board;

5.1.1.3 Strategic location and potential for academic, research, or institutional collaboration with higher education institutions or similar entities;

5.1.1.4 Availability or developability of human resources and essential support systems necessary for effective campus operations;

5.1.1.5 Financial viability and sustainability, including the availability of government appropriations and other lawful sources of funding for capital outlay and operational requirements; and

5.1.1.6 Such other technical, developmental, environmental, institutional, or governance-related considerations as the Board may deem appropriate.

5.1.2 The Board may amend or supplement the foregoing criteria as it deems necessary.

SEC. 6. PSHS System Campuses. - The PSHS System shall be composed of the existing PSHS campuses herein mentioned and future campuses which shall be established under the Act.

The existing sixteen (16) campuses shall be known as follows:

6.1 Philippine Science High School - Main Campus in Diliman, Quezon City;

6.2 Philippine Science High School - Cordillera Administrative Region Campus in Baguio City;

6.3 Philippine Science High School - Ilocos Region Campus in Ilocos Sur;

6.4 Philippine Science High School - Cagayan Valley Campus in Nueva Vizcaya;

6.5 Philippine Science High School - Central Luzon Campus in Clark Freeport Zone;

6.6 Philippine Science High School - CALABARZON Region Campus in Batangas City;

6.7 Philippine Science High School-MIMAROPA Region Campus in Romblon;

6.8 Philippine Science High School - Bicol Region Campus in Camarines Sur;

6.9 Philippine Science High School - Western Visayas Campus in Iloilo City;

6.10 Philippine Science High School - Central Visayas Campus in Cebu;

6.11 Philippine Science High School - Eastern Visayas Campus in Leyte;

6.12 Philippine Science High School - Zamboanga Peninsula Region Campus in Dipolog City;

6.13 Philippine Science High School - Northern Mindanao Campus in Lanao del Norte;

6.14 Philippine Science High School - Davao Region Campus in Davao City;

6.15 Philippine Science High School - SOCCSKSARGEN Region Campus in Koronadal City; and

6.16 Philippine Science High School - CARAGA Region Campus in Butuan City.

A Philippine Science High School campus in the Negros Island Region shall also be established.

In the establishment of future PSHS campuses, the Board may consider the following locations: First District of Aklan; Polangui, Albay; Ubay, Bohol; Laoag City, Ilocos Norte; Labangan, Zamboanga del Sur; Third District of Cagayan; General Santos City, South Cotabato; and Bukidnon.

The Quezon City Campus shall retain its status as the Main Campus. All future PSHS campuses shall bear the name of the region and the place where they will be established.

SEC. 7. Restriction on the Conversion and Inclusion of High Schools into a PSHS Campus. - The conversion and inclusion of existing high schools into the PSHS System shall not be allowed.

RULE IV - GOVERNANCE

SEC. 8. Creation of the PSHS System Board of Trustees. - There shall be created a Board of Trustees, composed of the following members:

- 8.1 Secretary of Science and Technology, as ex officio Chairperson;
- 8.2 Secretary of Education, as ex officio Vice Chairperson;
- 8.3 President of the University of the Philippines;
- 8.4 Executive Director of the PSHS System;
- 8.5 Director of the DOST-Science Education Institute;
- 8.6 President of the PSHS National Alumni Association;
- 8.7 Chairpersons of the Committee on Science and Technology of the Senate and the House of Representatives, as ex officio members;
- 8.8 One (1) representative each from the private sector, representing higher education, child development professionals or practitioners, industry, agriculture, and new emerging technologies.

The private sector representatives shall be appointed by the Board upon recommendation of a duly constituted search committee.

The private sector representatives shall serve a term of four (4) years and may be reappointed for another 4 years, subject to the discretion and approval of the Board.

SEC. 9. Powers and Functions of the PSHS System Board of Trustees. - The Board shall exercise the following powers and functions:

- 9.1 Formulate policies, guidelines, and criteria for the establishment, administration, operation, monitoring, and evaluation of PSHS campuses to ensure consistent quality standards;
- 9.2 Identify additional PSHS campuses as provided under Section 5 of this IRR, and the naming or renaming of existing or future campuses;
- 9.3 Formulate policies for the increase of enrollment in the PSHS System;
- 9.4 Approve the curriculum developed by the Executive Committee under Section 16 of this IRR;
- 9.5 Approve the criteria for the selection, admission, and lateral transfer of students;
- 9.6 Approve the grant and termination of scholarships, including stipend and allowances of students;
- 9.7 Approve the graduation of successful candidates from the various PSHS campuses;
- 9.8 Approve policies and disciplinary rules for students, faculty members, and staff;

- 9.9 Approve the organizational structure and staffing pattern of the PSHS System as prepared by the Executive Director, subject to the revised Compensation and Position Classification System, civil service laws, rules and regulations, and other relevant laws;
- 9.10 Formulate policies on appointment, promotion, retention or renewal of contracts, compensation, removal for just cause, rewards, incentives, and other conditions of employment;
- 9.11 Approve the selection criteria for Executive Director, Deputy Executive Directors, and Campus Directors, and the selection of teaching and non-teaching personnel;
- 9.12 Appoint the Executive Director, Deputy Executive Directors, Campus Directors, and the teaching and non-teaching personnel;
- 9.13 Reorganize the composition of the Executive Committee and other committees;
- 9.14 Approve the extension of services of faculty members over the age of sixty-five (65) up to the age of seventy (70) pursuant with Republic Act No. 8439, or the "Magna Carta for Scientists, Engineers, Researchers and other S&T Personnel in the Government", as amended, subject to existing guidelines;
- 9.15 Receive and appropriate for purposes herein specified such sums as may be provided by law for the support of the PSHS System;
- 9.16 Receive grants, bequests, endowments, gifts, donations, and contributions of cash and real and personal properties of all kinds, and administer the same for the benefit of the PSHS System or for aid to any of its students;
- 9.17 Authorize the utilization of income generated by the PSHS System to support its functions, and of donations received in trust by individual campuses, in accordance with the donor's specified purpose and the intended use of the donation: Provided, That for income or donations not designated for a particular campus, the Board shall allocate such income or donation for the benefit of the System or any of its campuses, as it may deem appropriate, subject to existing government accounting and auditing rules and regulations;
- 9.18 Receive support under the "Adopt-A-School Program" pursuant to RA 8525 and other related programs or laws for the improvement of its learning and research facilities and related activities;
- 9.19 Approve partnerships and collaborations entered into by the PSHS System and its campuses with local and international institutions; and
- 9.20 Perform such other functions as may be required under the Act and this IRR.

RULE V - MANAGEMENT AND STRUCTURE

SEC. 10. Executive Director. - The PSHS System shall be headed by an Executive Director (ED), who shall exercise academic and administrative supervision over all campuses and coordinate the implementation of policies and guidelines set by the Board.

10.1 The ED shall be appointed by the Board for a term of six (6) years and may be reappointed for another term of six (6) years, must have an advanced degree in the field of STEM and substantial experience in managing an educational institution. The minimum qualification for ED shall be set by the Board considering the CSC Minimum Qualification Standards (MQS).

10.2 The ED shall have the rank, privileges, and emoluments of Executive Director V and a salary grade of 30.

10.3 The ED shall be allowed to complete the term of six (6) years even upon reaching the mandatory age of retirement but shall no longer be eligible for reappointment for another term.

SEC. 11. Duties and Functions of the Executive Director. -

11.1 The ED shall exercise administrative supervision over all campus directors and shall be the primary implementor of policies and guidelines set by the Board. As a member of the Board, the ED shall articulate to the Board the mutual concerns of all campuses including students, employees, and other stakeholders.

11.2 The ED shall perform the following duties and functions:

11.2.1 Coordinate the implementation of Board-approved admission processes, criteria, and standards;

11.2.2 Facilitate and coordinate curriculum planning, review and evaluation activities, and research-based development in the PSHS System;

11.2.3 Monitor, coordinate, and evaluate research projects and initiatives in all PSHS campuses;

11.2.4 Manage the registration of intellectual property, prototype development, and the commercialization or adoption of research outputs of student and faculty;

11.2.5 Provide legal and technical assistance to students, faculty member and staff of the PSHS System in line with their studies and official functions;

11.2.5.1 The ED shall establish a legal and technical team that will provide continuous legal and technical assistance to the campuses.

11.2.6 Establish strategic linkages and coordinate exchange and training programs with local and international partners to enhance the expertise and competencies of students, faculty members, and staff;

11.2.7 Facilitate networking and sharing of resources, expertise, equipment, and technology across PSHS campuses with partner institutions to ensure access to advanced tools and facilities that support academic and research excellence;

11.2.7.1 The ED shall develop a system of complementation and sharing of resources, expertise, and equipment.

11.2.8 Supervise the development of a system-wide outreach program to upgrade STEM education, extend support to PSHS campuses, and facilitate partnerships with the Department of Education Science High Schools and Special Science Elementary and High School Programs within the capabilities and resources of various science high school campuses;

11.2.9 Recommend to the Board the organizational structure and staffing pattern of the PSHS System;

11.2.10 Serve as secretariat to the Board; and

11.2.11 Perform such other functions as may be necessary to implement the provisions of the Act.

In view of the expansion of the PSHS System, the office of the ED shall be provided with additional plantilla positions to be determined by the ED and approved by the Board.

SEC. 12. Deputy Executive Directors. - There shall be three (3) Deputy Executive Directors (DED), with the rank of Deputy Executive Director IV and a salary grade of 28, who shall assist the Executive Director. The minimum qualification for DED shall be set by the Board considering the CSC Minimum Qualification Standards (MQS).

12.1 The three (3) DED shall oversee the following services:

12.1.1 Academic and Student Services;

12.1.2 Administrative and Finance; and

12.1.3 Research, Innovation and Linkages.

12.2 The DED shall be appointed by the Board for a term of six (6) years and may be reappointed for another term of six (6) years, preferably holding an advanced degree in the field of STEM, and substantial experience in managing an educational institution. Detailed guidelines and qualifications of the DED shall be subject to the discretion and approval of the Board.

12.3 The Board shall define the scope of their respective offices and their duties and functions.

12.4 The DED shall be allowed to complete the term of six (6) years even upon reaching the mandatory age of retirement but shall no longer be eligible for reappointment for another term.

SEC. 13. Campus Director of the PSHS System Campuses. - Each PSHS campus shall have a Campus Director (CD) with a rank of Director III and a Salary Grade of 27, who shall serve as the administrative and academic head and be responsible for day-to-day operations. The CD may constitute a consultative body to act as a citizen's arm to assess and determine the educational needs of a campus service area. The minimum qualification for CD shall be set by the Board considering the CSC Minimum Qualification Standards (MQS).

13.1 The CD shall be appointed by the Board, upon recommendation of the ED, for a term of six (6) years and may be reappointed for another term of six (6) years, preferably holding an advanced degree in the field of STEM, and substantial experience in managing an educational institution. Detailed guidelines and qualifications of the CD shall be subject to the discretion and approval of the Board.

13.2 The CD shall be allowed to complete the term of six (6) years even upon reaching the mandatory age of retirement but shall no longer be eligible for reappointment for another term.

SEC. 14. Filling Up of Vacancy. - In the event of a vacancy in the position of ED, DED, and CD, the replacement or new appointee's term of office shall be considered as a new appointment and shall serve for a full term.

SEC. 15. Organizational Structure and Staffing Pattern. - The ED shall prepare the organizational structure and staffing pattern required for the expanded PSHS System, including additional plantilla positions, reclassification or staffing modifications, and qualifications of the PSHS System personnel in accordance with the Revised Compensation and Position

Classification System, civil service laws, rules, regulations, and other relevant issuances, taking into consideration the specialized science teacher status of faculty members.

Upon approval of the Board, the organizational structure and staffing pattern shall be submitted to the Department of Budget and Management (DBM) for review and approval.

The PSHS System shall retain its existing organizational structure and staffing pattern pending approval by the DBM.

SEC. 16. Executive Committee. - There shall be an Executive Committee composed of:

16.1 Executive Director as ex officio chairperson;

16.2 Deputy Executive Directors as ex officio members;

16.3 Campus Directors as members; and

16.4 Other ranking PSHS System faculty members or officials, as the Board may deem necessary, as members.

The Executive Committee shall develop and conduct a periodic review of the PSHS System curriculum and other training programs, and exercise such other functions, powers, and duties as the Board may prescribe. The committee shall be collegial in character.

RULE VI - FACULTY PERSONNEL POLICIES AND STANDARDS

SEC. 17. Faculty Members Qualification. - Faculty members of the PSHS System shall be exempt from any civil service examination or regulations as a requisite to appointment. The same shall be selected in accordance with such criteria as may be formulated and approved by the Board such as, but not limited to, screening and conduct of competitive examinations.

17.1 The PSHS System Merit Selection Plan shall cover all conditions of employment to teaching positions specifically:

17.1.1 Hiring of new teachers to fill up new vacant position;

17.1.2 Transfers from other campuses of the PSHS System; and

17.1.3 Promotion of teachers holding permanent positions including those who are in the active service, on local or foreign scholarship or training grant or on maternity leave.

RULE VII - EXEMPTION FROM TAX

SEC. 18. Exemption from Tax. - All grants, bequests, endowments, gifts, donations and contributions made to and used actually, directly, and exclusively for educational purposes by the PSHS System shall be exempt from donor's tax and the same shall be considered as allowable deductions from gross income for purposes of computing the taxable income of the donor, pursuant to the provisions of Republic Act No. 8424, or the "National Internal Revenue Code of 1997", as amended.

The importation of scientific and research equipment for educational purposes made by the PSHS System, upon certification by the DOST, shall be exempt from the payment of taxes, and customs duties in accordance with the provisions of RA 10863, otherwise known as the "Customs Modernization and Tariff Act (CMTA)." Should any taxes and duties be assessed on importations not covered by said exemption under the CMTA, the same shall be chargeable against the tax expenditure fund under the General Appropriations Act (GAA).

RULE VIII - FALLBACK POSITION

SEC. 19. Fallback Position. - At the end of two (2) consecutive terms, the ED, DED, or CD may opt to remain with the PSHS System and occupy the highest faculty rank.

19.1 The PSHS System Merit Selection Plan shall provide the guideline and/or procedure for the fallback position.

RULE IX - TRANSITORY PROVISION

SEC. 20. Transitory Provision.

20.1 The following incumbent key officials of the PSHS System shall acquire new terms of office:

20.1.1 Non-ex-officio members of the Board under Section 8 of this IRR shall assume a term of four (4) years;

20.1.2 The ED and DED, subject to meritorious performance and upon approval of the Board, shall assume a term of six (6) years, and may be renewed for another term of six (6) years; and

20.1.3 The CD, subject to meritorious performance and approval of the Board, shall assume a term of six (6) years, and may be renewed for another term of six (6) years.

RULE X - MISCELLANEOUS PROVISIONS

SEC. 21. Appropriations. - The amount necessary to carry out the initial implementation of the Act shall be charged against the current year's appropriations of the PSHS System. Thereafter, such amount as may be needed for its continued operation shall be included in the annual GAA, subject to existing government accounting and auditing rules and regulations.

SEC. 22. Separability Clause. - If any provision or part of this IRR is declared unconstitutional or invalid, the remainder thereof not otherwise affected shall be in full force and effect.

SEC. 23. Repealing Clause. - Republic Act No. 3661 or "An Act to Establish the Philippine Science High School", and Republic Act No. 8496 as amended by Republic Act No. 9036, or the "Philippine Science High School (PSHS) System Act of 1997" are hereby repealed. All laws, presidential decrees, executive orders, letters of instruction, proclamations, or administrative regulations that are inconsistent with the provisions of RA No. 12310 are hereby amended, repealed, or modified accordingly.

SEC. 24. Effectivity. - This IRR shall take effect fifteen (15) days from the date of its publication in the Official Gazette or in a newspaper of general circulation.

Approved 29 April 2026.

(Sgd.) RENATO U. SOLIDUM, JR.

Chairperson, Philippine Science High School System Board of Trustees

Secretary, Department of Science and Technology